

CGC ULTIMATE ARCADE 2

Multicade Service & Placement Guide

Chicago Gaming Company commercial multicade — reliability for public use

Prepared for **Coin Op 4 Charity** / Arcade Angels

Keeping a modern commercial multicade reliable and inviting for youth centers and community spaces

1. Overview & Goals

The Chicago Gaming Company (CGC) Ultimate Arcade 2 is a commercial-quality upright multicade containing a large licensed library of classic arcade titles (approximately 100 games from Atari, Capcom, Taito, Midway, Stern, Exidy, Incredible Technologies, and others). It features a commercial cabinet, typically a 24" monitor protected by tempered glass, lighted marquee, and two-player arcade controls. Many units were sold with the coin door deactivated for free-play home or commercial use. For youth-center and community placements the priorities are reliability, clean presentation, responsive controls, and simple ongoing care.

2. Safety

- Unplug the cabinet before opening it or working on internal components.
- Although this is a modern commercial machine, treat power supplies and internal wiring with normal electrical caution.
- Tempered glass protects the monitor — handle carefully if removal is ever required.
- Keep the interior free of loose tools or parts before closing the machine for public use.

3. Cabinet Exterior & Cosmetics

- Clean the exterior thoroughly with mild cleaner. Remove fingerprints, sticky residue, and dust from side art, front, and control panel area.
- Inspect side art, decals, and bezel for peeling or heavy damage. Touch up or replace sections that make the machine look neglected.
- Marquee: clean the plastic and confirm the lighting works. Replace the tube or LED lighting if dim so the machine stays inviting.
- Coin door: if present and locked, confirm keys are available or convert/document free-play status for the placement site.
- Level the cabinet so it sits solidly with no rocking.

4. Control Panel — Joysticks, Buttons & Trackball (if equipped)

Two-player controls are the primary player contact point. Clean or replace sticky buttons. Inspect microswitches under joysticks and buttons; clean contacts and adjust for positive, reliable actuation. Rebuild or replace worn joysticks (bushings, actuators, restrictor plates) so movement is smooth and accurate in all directions. If the unit has a trackball, clean the ball, rollers, and sensors thoroughly and confirm smooth tracking. A worn or peeling control-panel overlay should be replaced for both appearance and hygiene in public settings.

5. Power Supply & Internal Connections

Confirm the power supply is delivering stable voltages under load. Check all major connectors (JAMMA or proprietary harnesses, monitor power, control panel harness) for firm seating and clean contacts. Dust the interior, especially around the power supply and any fans or vents. Heat and dust are the main enemies of long-term reliability on commercial multicades. Replace any scorched or loose fuse holders and verify correct fuse values.

6. Game Board / System Board

The Ultimate Arcade 2 uses a dedicated multicade PCB with a fixed licensed game library. Reseat the board and any daughter cards firmly. Clean edge connectors if accessible. If the machine fails to boot or individual games lock up, confirm power and harness integrity first before assuming a board fault. Document the approximate game count and any known non-working titles for future volunteers. Replacement or donor boards occasionally appear on the secondary market; keep notes of any board swaps.

7. Monitor & Glass

Most units use a commercial 24" monitor behind tempered safety glass. Clean the glass carefully (both sides if accessible). Confirm the picture is bright, focused, and free of major geometry or color issues from normal player distance. If the original CRT-style or LCD panel develops problems, professional monitor service or a compatible replacement panel may be required. Avoid forcing the glass or bezel — tempered glass can break if stressed incorrectly.

8. Sound, Coin / Free-Play & Interior Care

- Confirm speakers produce clean sound at reasonable volume across several games. Replace if distorted or weak.
- Many Ultimate Arcade 2 units ship with the coin door deactivated for free play. Confirm and document the free-play status for the host site.
- Clear dust from the interior on a regular schedule. Keep vents and any cooling paths open.
- Confirm the rear interlock or access-panel switch (if present) functions correctly for safety.

9. Final Testing Checklist Before Placement

- Full cold boot to the game-selection menu with correct picture and sound
- Player 1 and Player 2 joysticks move cleanly in all directions with no dead zones
- All buttons (including Start and any extra function buttons) register reliably
- Trackball (if equipped) tracks smoothly
- Test a representative selection of games from different eras/publishers for freezes or input issues
- Monitor picture is clear and bright enough from normal player distance
- Cabinet exterior is clean, level, and free of sharp edges or loose parts
- Marquee is lit and readable
- Free-play status is correctly set and documented for the host site
- Keys, spare fuses, and a short instruction sheet are bagged and labeled for the host organization

10. Notes for Host Sites

Provide a short one-page sheet: how to power the machine on/off, free-play status, and who to contact for problems. Recommend a simple weekly wipe-down of the control panel, glass, and trackball (if present). Ask the host to report any new stickiness, missing games, picture changes, or freezes early. Document the approximate game library and any known non-working titles or non-original parts so future volunteers know what they are looking at.

This guide is intended for educational and nonprofit service use by Coin Op 4 Charity and partner organizations. The goal is a multicade that stays reliable, safe, and fun for the people who actually play it.

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